

Ah! An interconnected world. But how will it help?

Imagine travelling from your home to your school, college or office without any traffic. Let's say there happens to be an accident along the way, these intelligent devices will alert you while you drive. Or suppose that on one of the days you're out travelling, many other vehicles are also concurrently on the road. This will lead to traffic snarls along the highway. Smart vehicles will check for any such occurrences, alert you and maybe suggest an alternate route. Thus apart from saving time, they'll save you money and fuel.

The Internet of Things is actually a network of devices called 'Things' that are connected to each other (inter-networked) using the Internet to enable communication among the Things (devices).



Future smart highways

Convenience by automation

Let's take another case. You're out of town for some reason and will be reaching home late. However, a relative is coming over to your house when you're not there. Even though you're outside, you could just authorise

the person to enter your home, yet lock down the sensitive parts of your home such as locker etc.

In the future, smart villages and cities will inform relevant authorities about emergencies and might even help avert impending catastrophe. Sensors will monitor current situations and record changing conditions, and any undesired changes in the environment will be given special attention.

To give an existing example of a smart network, some countries in the world have modified their electricity grid to record voltages, current, frequency and power consumption at various places. In this way, electricity can be supplied as per demand. Some have even gone a step further by letting appliances be completely switched on and off. If there's a need to completely switch off electricity in some region, say, in case of a short circuit, a complete blackout is avoided.